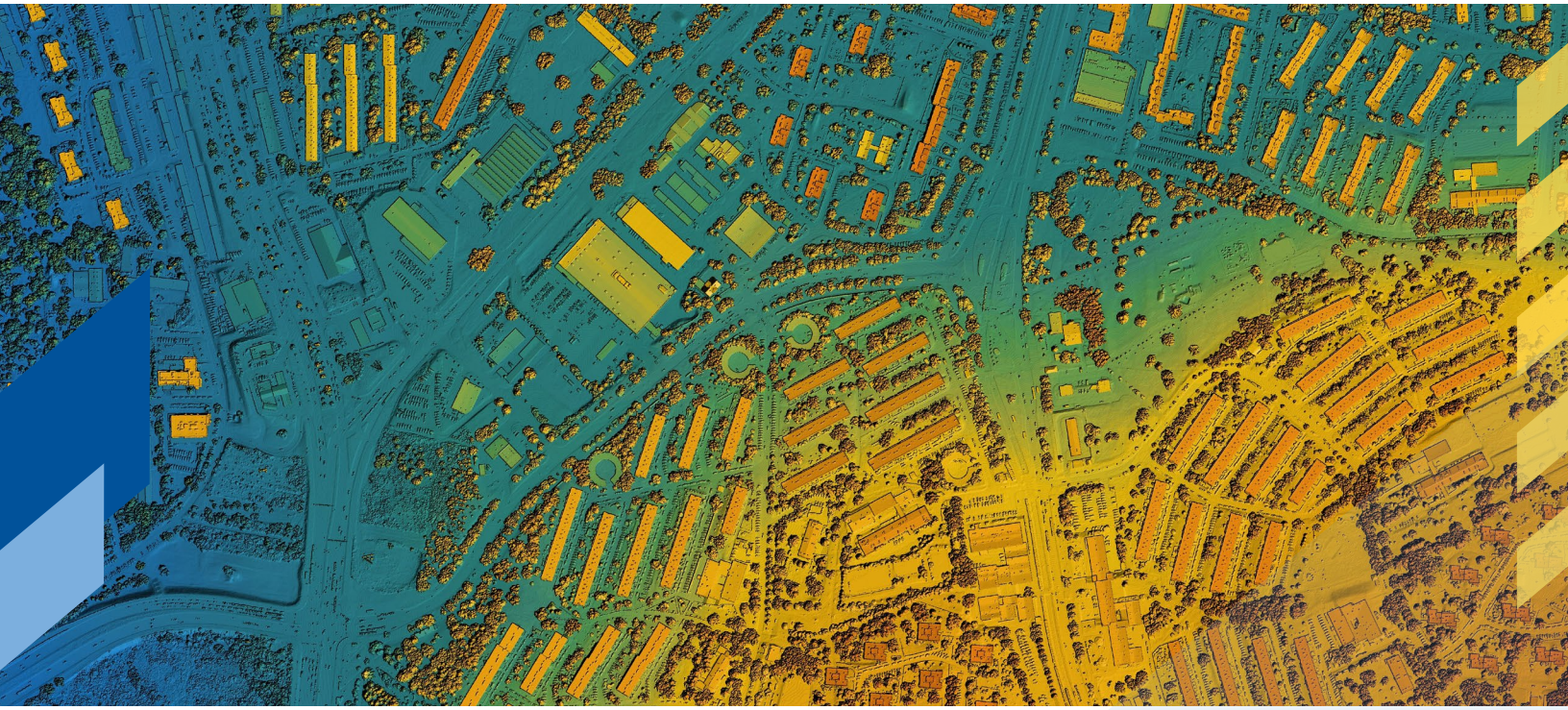
GEOGRAPHY

Bachelor of Arts



Central to Mapping the Future.

Central's BA in Geography prepares students for the fields of urban planning, environmental, sustainability, social science teaching, and Geographic Information Sciences (GIS) applications. Students receive a holistic, liberal education that integrates the study of human activity and the natural environment.

> After I graduate, I will be traveling to Madagascar as part of a volunteer program called International Volunteer HQ (IVHQ). The trip will be for about 12 weeks and during that time I will be scuba diving to help collect data on coral reefs for researchers that work to preserve and protect their habitat. Studying Geography, especially GIS since what I will be doing is pretty much the front lines of it all; has made me more and more excited to not only learn about the world but to go out and experience it first hand as well.
>
> – Matthew Tattersall

Program Features

- Programs bridge the social sciences, sciences, and humanities
- Coursework with an international orientation offered
- Small department with a welcoming environment
- Opportunities for hands-on applied field work through courses abroad
- Specialized tracks allow students to pursue education in individual interests while still earning employable skills
- Financial aid and scholarships available
- Free on-campus child care available

CENTRAL CONNECTICUT STATE UNIVERSITY

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Program Options

- **Environmental Geography & Sustainability, BA:** Students gain an understanding of the impact of human interactions with the environment and physical systems of the earth. Graduates are prepared for careers in resource management, environmental & sustainable planning, outdoor/environmental education, environmental assessment/monitoring/restoration, and air/water/soil pollution prevention.
- **General/Regional Geography, BA/BS (BS Certifiable for Elementary Education):** Provides a broad overview of the discipline of Geography and what it has to offer. Primarily designed for education majors, however, also a great option for those who want a little bit of everything Geography has to offer.
- **Geographic Information Science, BA:** Prepares students for careers in Geographic Information System (GIS) Mapping and Remote Sensing (RS), as well as their applications in fields like planning, marketing, crime mapping, health, environmental protection, and natural resources management
- **Planning, BA:** Equips students for jobs as town or city planners with municipalities, as regional planners for regional councils of government, and for positions at state agencies, non-profits, and private consulting firms. Introduces students to the historical, legal, and applied contexts of planning in the United States and Connecticut, as well as subfields of planning, such as transportation planning, urban design, environmental planning, and economic development.
- **Tourism, BA:** Prepares students to work in municipal, state, and federal agencies for positions such as planning, parks and recreation, ecotourism/nature-based tourism, cultural/historical tourism, and tourism development.

> I chose to pursue my graduate degree in Geography at Central because of the flexibility of the program. I was able to customize my curriculum to focus on the aspects of Geography that would best suit my career goals. Now I'm working at a global firm as a Transportation Planner - just where I wanted to be.
> – Caryn DeCrisanti

Clubs

Gamma Theta Upsilon serves as the international honor society for Geography. Members must meet academic requirements and share a background and interest in Geography.

Central **Geographical Society** members serve as ambassadors for the field, the department, and Central to the community at large.

Tourism and Hospitality Studies Club promotes professional, academic, and personal development of students by furthering opportunities for industry networking and career development.

Career Preparation

Graduates leave the program ready to fill jobs in the public, private, and non-profit sectors or to further their education at the graduate and doctoral levels.

DID YOU KNOW?

The Association of American Geographers has an excellent career overview that is very much applicable for the kinds of employment that our students land in after graduation. Some occupations that could be held by graduates are:

- Geospatial Information Scientists/Technologists
- Geosphysical Data Technicians
- Geographic Information Systems Technicians
- Cartographers and Photogrammetrists
- Urban and Regional Planners
- Transportation Planners

Source: aag.org/jobs-careers

PROGRAM WEBSITE

ABOUT CENTRAL:
Central Connecticut State University is the largest university within the Connecticut State Colleges and Universities system. Founded in 1849, Central is also the state's oldest publicly funded university. Our campus is located in New Britain, Connecticut. Central is accredited by the New England Commission of Higher Education (NECHE).

Information is subject to change. Please visit our website or contact undergraduate admissions for the most up to date information.